



In this picture from the London 1948 Olympic Games, the Indian hockey team is seen playing against the Spanish team in a hockey match at Chiswick.

Promoting athletes

The Indian Railways Athletic Association, the first formal body for the organization of sports in the railways, established as early as 1928, was renamed, and finally rechristened the Railway Sports Promotion Board (RSPB) in 1998. This was done to reflect the Board's role in promoting sports at national and international levels. An apex body, the RSPB coordinates and builds liaisons with different national sports federations and 30 railway sports associations. It is treated as a separate national sports organization, as it is affiliated to the Union Sportive Internationale des Cheminots, and is also a member of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI). In 2009 and 2012, it was awarded the Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, for "Employment of Sportspersons and Sports Welfare" and "Financial Support for Sports Excellence".